

Answer Key

Grammar

Past Simple

We use the past simple for finished actions or situations at a definite time in the past. Regular verbs add -ed; many common verbs are irregular.

Geçmişte belirli bir zamanda tamamlanmış eylemler veya durumlar için past simple kullanılır. Düzenli fiillere -ed eklenir; birçok yaygın fiil ise düzensizdir.

When? Use it for a single finished action, a series of finished actions, or a past state that is now over.

Tek bir tamamlanmış eylem, art arda gelen tamamlanmış eylemler veya artık bitmiş bir geçmiş durum için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + V2 (regular: verb + -ed)
- She worked hard.
- They moved to a new city.

Negative

- Subject + didn't + base verb
- She didn't give up.
- They didn't have much money.

Question

- Did + subject + base verb...?
- Did she work hard?
- Did they move to a new city?

Short answers

- Yes, she did. / No, she didn't.
- Yes, they did. / No, they didn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~She not worked hard.~~ → **She didn't work hard.**
- ~~Did she moved to the city?~~ → **Did she move to the city?**
- ~~He goed to school every day.~~ → **He went to school every day.**

1. When she was a child, her family _____ (not have) a car. **(didn't have)**

Negative past simple: didn't + base verb.

2. Which sentence is correct?

- a. She study every night.
- b. She studied every night. ✓
- c. She studying every night.
- d. She studies every night ago.

'studied' is the correct past simple form.

3. _____ they move to a bigger house last year? (question) **(Did)**

Questions in the past simple begin with 'Did'.

4. He didn't gave up on his dream. — True / False **(Incorrect — He didn't give up on his dream.)**

5. Put the words in order: hard / worked / two / jobs / she

She worked hard at two jobs. Abi Online English - Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Answer Key · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

6. Rewrite in the negative: They had enough money. **They didn't have enough money.**

7. Choose the correct irregular past form of 'lose'.

- ☐ a. losed
- ☒ b. lost ✓
- ☐ c. loses
- ☐ d. losing

'lose' is irregular: lose → lost.

8. Despite the hardship, the family _____ (survive) together. **(survived)**

Regular past simple form.

9. Turn into a question: She finished school at 18. **Did she finish school at 18?**

10. Put the words in order: overcome / the / difficult / he / years / most

He overcame the most difficult years.

Past Continuous (and Past Continuous with 'while')

We use the past continuous (was/were + verb-ing) for an action in progress at a specific moment in the past, or for two actions happening at the same time, often linked with 'while'.

Past continuous (was/were + fiil-ing), geçmişte belirli bir anda devam eden bir eylem için veya genellikle 'while' ile bağlanan, aynı anda gerçekleşen iki eylem için kullanılır.

When? Use it for background actions in progress, actions interrupted by another action (with past simple), or two parallel actions with 'while'.

Devam etmekte olan arka plan eylemleri, başka bir eylem tarafından kesilen eylemler (past simple ile birlikte) veya 'while' ile ifade edilen iki paralel eylem için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + was/were + verb-ing
- She was studying at night.
- They were working long hours.

Negative

- Subject + wasn't/weren't + verb-ing
- He wasn't earning much.
- They weren't sleeping well.

Question

- Was/Were + subject + verb-ing...?
- Was she studying?
- Were they working long hours?

Short answers

- Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.
- Yes, they were. / No, they weren't.

Common mistakes

- ~~She was study when the phone rang.~~ → **She was studying when the phone rang.**
- ~~While she was studying, her mother cooked.~~ → **While she was studying, her mother was cooking.**
- ~~They was working hard.~~ → **They were working hard.**

1. At 9 p.m. last night, she _____ (write) her homework. **(was writing)**

Past continuous for an action in progress at a specific time.

2. While his parents were working, he _____ his younger brothers.

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- a. look after
 - b. was looking after ✓
 - c. looked after
 - d. looking after

Two parallel background actions usually both take the past continuous.

3. _____ you _____ (sleep) when the storm started? **(Were / sleeping)**

Past continuous question form.

4. They were not sleeping well during that period. — True / False **(Correct)**

5. Put the words in order: was / while / studying / she / working / her / brother / was

While she was studying, her brother was working.

6. Combine using 'while': He was cooking. His sister was cleaning. **While he was cooking, his sister was cleaning.**

7. While the family _____ (struggle) financially, neighbours _____ (bring) them food. **(were struggling / were bringing)**

Two parallel past continuous actions with 'while'.

8. Put the words in order: doing / were / arrived / letter / what / the / when / you

What were you doing when the letter arrived?

Used to

We use 'used to' + base verb to talk about repeated past habits or past states that are no longer true.

'Used to' + fiilin yalın hali, artık doğru olmayan tekrarlanan geçmiş alışkanlıkları veya geçmiş durumları anlatmak için kullanılır.

When? Use it to contrast a past habit/state with the present situation. Do not use it for a single, one-time action.

Geçmişteki bir alışkanlığı/durumu şimdiki durumla karşılaştırmak için kullanılır. Tek seferlik bir eylem için kullanılmaz.

Positive

- Subject + used to + base verb
- He used to walk to school.
- They used to live in a village.

Negative

- Subject + didn't use to + base verb
- She didn't use to eat meat.
- We didn't use to have a car.

Question

- Did + subject + use to + base verb...?
- Did he use to walk to school?
- Did they use to live in a village?

Short answers

- Yes, he did. / No, he didn't.
- Yes, they did. / No, they didn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~He use to walk to school.~~ → **He used to walk to school.**
- ~~She didn't used to eat meat.~~ → **She didn't use to eat meat.**

- ~~I used to go to the cinema yesterday.~~ → **I went to the cinema yesterday.**

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1. They _____ (live) in a small village before they moved to the city. **(used to live)**

used to + base verb for a past state.

2. Which is correct?

- a. She didn't used to smile much.
- b. She didn't use to smile much. ✓
- c. She not used to smile much.
- d. She use to not smile much.

Negative form: didn't use to (no -d after didn't).

3. _____ you _____ (play) outside all day when you were a child? **(Did / use to play)**

Question form: Did + subject + use to + base verb.

4. He use to work in a shoe factory. — True / False **(Incorrect — He used to work in a shoe factory.)**

5. Rewrite using 'used to': In the past, she had very little money. **She used to have very little money.**

6. Put the words in order: school / walk / to / used / he / to

He used to walk to school.

7. We _____ (not have) enough food during the hardest years, but things are better now. **(didn't use to have)**

Negative form for a past state contrasted with the present.

8. Explain the difference: 'I used to go to that school' vs 'I went to that school yesterday'. **'Used to' describes a repeated past habit or state with no specific time; the past simple with 'yesterday' describes one finished action at a specific time.**

The Girl Who Didn't Stop

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think 'didn't stop' might mean here?
- Have you ever heard a true story about someone who overcame a difficult childhood?

Elif grew up in a small town where her family didn't have much money. Her father worked long hours at a local workshop, and her mother sold vegetables at the market. When Elif was ten years old, her father lost his job, and things became even harder. The family moved into a smaller house, and Elif started helping her mother at the market every morning before school.

While her classmates were playing after school, Elif was usually working or studying by candlelight, because the electricity at home was often cut off. She used to dream about becoming a teacher one day, but nobody in her family had ever finished university. Many people told her it wasn't realistic for a girl from her background.

Elif didn't listen to them. She studied every night, even when she was exhausted, and she never missed a day of school. One teacher noticed how determined she was and began giving her extra books to read. Slowly, Elif's grades improved, and after years of hard work, she won a scholarship to study education at a university in another city.

Today, Elif is a teacher at a school not far from the town where she grew up. She often tells her students that hard times don't have to decide who you become. 'I used to think poverty would stop me,' she says, 'but it actually taught me how to keep going.' Her story has since inspired several of her own students to keep studying, no matter how difficult their situation is.

1. What was the main obstacle in Elif's early life?

- a. She was ill for many years.
- b. Her family had very little money. ✓
- c. She didn't like school.
- d. She lived far from her family.

The text says her family didn't have much money and that things got harder after her father lost his job.

2. Elif used to help her mother at the _____ every morning. **(market)**

The text says her mother sold vegetables at the market and Elif helped her there.

3. Elif's family had electricity all the time. — True / False **(Incorrect — Elif's family often had the electricity cut off.)**

4. What helped Elif improve her grades?

- a. Moving to a bigger house
- b. Her father's new job
- c. A teacher who gave her extra books ✓
- d. Stopping work at the market

A teacher noticed her determination and gave her extra books to read.

5. Elif won a _____ to study education at university. **(scholarship)**

The text states she won a scholarship.

6. According to Elif, what did poverty actually teach her?

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- ☐ a. To give up early
 - ☒ b. How to keep going ✓
 - ☐ c. To avoid school
 - ☐ d. To depend on others

She says poverty 'taught me how to keep going'.

After you read

- Do you agree that hard times can teach us something useful? Why or why not?
- What would you say to a friend who feels like giving up during a difficult time?

From the Repair Shop to the Stage

Before you read

- What jobs do you know that require working with your hands?
- Do you think it's possible to follow a dream while working a difficult job?

Kerem's father used to run a small bicycle repair shop, and Kerem started helping him there when he was only eleven. While other children in the neighbourhood were going to after-school clubs, Kerem was fixing tyres and cleaning chains. The family needed the extra income, so there wasn't much time left for hobbies.

One rainy afternoon, while Kerem was repairing an old guitar that a customer had left behind, he started playing a few notes just to test the strings. He had never had lessons, but something about the sound stayed with him. From that day, whenever the shop was quiet, he practised on that same guitar, teaching himself simple songs from an old book his uncle had given him.

Life didn't get easier quickly. Kerem still worked at the shop every afternoon, and money was often tight at home. But he used to save a little money from small jobs to buy guitar strings, and he never stopped practising, even during the hardest months when the shop had almost no customers.

Years later, a local café owner heard Kerem playing outside the repair shop and asked him to perform one evening. That first small concert led to others, and slowly Kerem built a name for himself as a musician in his city. He still visits the repair shop sometimes, not to fix bicycles, but to remind himself where his journey began.

1. What was Kerem's family business?

- ☐ a. A music shop
- ☒ b. A bicycle repair shop ✓
- ☐ c. A café
- ☐ d. A bookshop

The text says his father ran a small bicycle repair shop.

2. Kerem first started playing an old _____ that a customer had left. (guitar)

He found an old guitar left by a customer for repair.

3. Kerem had professional guitar lessons from the start. — True / False (Incorrect — Kerem taught himself to play using an old book.)

4. How did Kerem get his first chance to perform?

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- ☐ a. He entered a competition.
 - ☒ b. A café owner heard him playing outside the shop. ✓
 - ☐ c. His uncle organised a concert.
 - ☐ d. He advertised online.

A local café owner heard him playing and invited him to perform.

5. Kerem used to save money from small jobs to buy guitar _____. (strings)

He saved money to buy guitar strings.

After you read

- What does this story suggest about combining work and following a passion?
- Do you know someone who kept a hobby going during a difficult time? Tell your partner about it.

A Conversation About Hard Times

Before you listen

- What kinds of hard times might a family go through?
- Predict: what do you think these two speakers will talk about?

1. Why did speaker A's family move house so often?

- a. They liked new places.
- b. Their house was too small.
- c. The father kept losing his job. ✓
- d. They wanted to be near school.

Speaker A says 'my dad kept losing his job'.

2. Speaker A was studying for exams while the family was _____ boxes. (packing)

Speaker A mentions studying while packing boxes to move.

3. No one helped speaker A with school. — True / False (Incorrect — A couple of teachers helped speaker A a lot.)

4. What did speaker A used to do while other students went home?

- a. Go home early too
- b. Stay late for extra help ✓
- c. Play sports
- d. Work part-time

Speaker A used to stay late to get extra help.

5. How does speaker A feel about that period now?

- a. Still angry about it
- b. Thinks it taught them to adapt quickly ✓
- c. Doesn't want to talk about it
- d. Wishes it never happened

Speaker A says it 'taught me to adapt quickly to new situations'.

Transcript (teacher use)

A You know, when I was a kid, we used to move house almost every year.

B Really? Why was that?

A My dad kept losing his job, so we were always looking for cheaper places to live.

B That must have been really hard, especially for school.

A It was. I remember one year I was studying for exams while we were packing boxes to move again.

B How did you manage to keep up with school?

A Honestly, a couple of teachers helped me a lot. While the other students were going home, I used to stay late to get extra help.

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B That's amazing. Do you think that time made you stronger?

A Definitely. I used to hate how unstable everything was, but now I think it taught me to adapt quickly to new situations.

B That's a really positive way to look at it.

Revision

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1. When he was young, his family _____ (not have) much money. **(didn't have)**

Negative past simple.

2. Which word means 'to deal successfully with a difficulty'?

- a. struggle
- b. overcome ✓
- c. sacrifice
- d. reflect

'Overcome' means to successfully deal with a difficulty.

3. While she _____ (study), her brother was cleaning the house. **(was studying)**

Past continuous for a background action with 'while'.

4. He use to work in his uncle's shop. — True / False **(Incorrect — He used to work in his uncle's shop.)**

5. In the reading 'The Girl Who Didn't Stop', what did Elif win?

- a. A job
- b. A scholarship ✓
- c. A prize for writing
- d. A house

Elif won a scholarship to study education.

6. _____ you _____ (sleep) when the phone rang last night? **(Were / sleeping)**

Past continuous question form.

7. In the listening, why did speaker A's family move so often?

- a. They liked travelling.
- b. The father kept losing his job. ✓
- c. Their house was too small.
- d. They wanted a bigger garden.

The father kept losing his job.

8. Rewrite with 'used to': In the past, they lived in a small village. **They used to live in a small village.**

9. Put the words in order: overcame / hardship / she / great / a

She overcame a great hardship.

10. Which sentence correctly combines two past continuous actions?

- a. While he was working, she studied.
- b. While he worked, she was studying.
- c. While he was working, she was studying. ✓
- d. While he working, she was studying.

Both parallel background actions take the past continuous.

1. Choose the correct meaning of 'resilient'.

- a. weak
- b. able to recover quickly from difficulty ✓
- c. wealthy
- d. forgetful

'Resilient' means able to recover quickly from difficulty.

2. Her parents made a lot of _____ so she could study abroad. (give up something important) **(sacrifices)**

'Sacrifice' fits the meaning of giving up something important for someone else.

3. Which word best completes: 'Losing his job was a big _____ for the family.'

- a. achievement
- b. obstacle ✓
- c. opportunity
- d. support

'Obstacle' fits as a difficulty the family had to deal with.

1. They _____ (not have) enough food during the hardest winter. **(didn't have)**

Negative past simple.

2. Choose the correct sentence.

- a. While she was cooking, the phone was ringing suddenly.
- b. While she was cooking, the phone rang. ✓
- c. While she cooked, the phone was ringing.
- d. While she was cook, the phone rang.

The shorter interrupting action takes the past simple; the longer background action takes the past continuous.

3. He _____ (walk) to school every day when he was a child. **(used to walk)**

used to + base verb for a repeated past habit.

4. She didn't used to like vegetables. — True / False **(Incorrect — She didn't use to like vegetables.)**

1. In 'From the Repair Shop to the Stage', what was Kerem's family business?

- a. A café
- b. A bicycle repair shop ✓
- c. A music school
- d. A bookshop

His father ran a bicycle repair shop.

2. Kerem taught himself guitar using an old _____ his uncle gave him. **(book)**

He taught himself with an old book from his uncle.

1. What did speaker A do while other students went home?

- AbOnlineEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Answer Key · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.
- ☐ a. Went home too
 - ☒ b. Stayed late for extra help ✓
 - ☐ c. Played sports
 - ☐ d. Worked in a shop

Speaker A stayed late to get extra help from teachers.